

AKASH VASHISTA

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AI QA Engineer | Quality & Reliability | Python & Playwright Automation | AI/LLM Application Testing | REST API, SQL & Azure CI/CD

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Quality and reliability-focused AI QA Engineer with over 6 years of experience designing and implementing automated testing frameworks, verifying complex data workflows, and driving product stability across AI-powered software products and enterprise SaaS applications. Holds a Master of Science in Computer Science and brings hands-on expertise building scalable end-to-end automation in Python and Playwright, validating REST APIs, and writing comprehensive SQL queries to ensure relational database integrity. A pioneer in AI-assisted testing and LLM agentic workflows, experienced in investigating production logs, partnering closely with software engineers, and embedding continuous quality gates into Azure DevOps and CI/CD pipelines.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI Quality Engineering & Test Automation: AI & LLM-Powered Application Testing & Workflow Validation, End-to-End Test Automation (Playwright, Python, TypeScript, Selenium), API Automation & Backend Verification (REST APIs, Postman, Newman, GraphQL), Automated Test Framework Architecture & Reusable Tooling, Regression, Integration, Exploratory & User Acceptance Testing (UAT), Defect Reproduction, Root-Cause Analysis & Log Investigation

Data Integrity & Database Testing: Relational Database Verification & SQL Querying (SQL Server, PostgreSQL), Backend Data Integrity & Workflow Validation, Schema Verification & Complex Query Optimization for QA, Compatibility Testing Across Relational & NoSQL Datastores (MongoDB, AWS Redshift)

Cloud, DevOps & Reliability: Continuous Testing & CI/CD Quality Gates (Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Jenkins), Containerization & Environment Configuration (Docker, Kubernetes), Cloud Infrastructure & Service Validation (Azure, AWS Lambda, S3, Cognito), Observability, Application Logs & Production Issue Investigation, Version Control & Peer Code Reviews (Git, GitHub)

Quality Leadership & Collaboration: Cross-Functional Collaboration with Developers & Product Teams, Sprint Planning, Risk Identification & Release Readiness, Defect Lifecycle Management (Jira, X-Ray, Zephyr, Azure DevOps), User Acceptance Testing, Onboarding & User Feedback Translation, Mentoring Junior Engineers & Engineering Community Enablement

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

AI & Modern Quality Engineering: Pioneered AI-agent workflows and prompt tools (Claude) to accelerate test scenario creation, explore complex user flows, and improve defect detection across next-generation software products.

Python & Playwright Automation: Proven track record architecting and maintaining robust automated test suites using Playwright, Python, and TypeScript, expanding regression coverage by 60% and reducing flakiness.

Database & Backend Data Integrity: Skilled in writing complex SQL queries across relational databases to verify transactional consistency, validate end-to-end data pipelines, and diagnose subtle backend defects.

Azure DevOps & Continuous Quality Gates: Deep experience integrating automated regression test suites into Azure DevOps and GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines, establishing clear pass/fail quality gates for biweekly releases.

Cross-Functional Partnership & Reliability: Collaborative tester who works directly with developers throughout the development cycle, diving into logs and telemetry to rapidly reproduce and resolve production issues.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Automation Specialist – Plato *May 2023 - Feb 2026*

- Built end-to-end UI and API automation frameworks using Playwright and TypeScript integrated with AI agents, reducing test development effort and accelerating regression coverage by 60%.
- Designed reusable AI-agent skills and workflows (Claude) to accelerate test-case creation, automation development, defect triage, and validation of new application features.
- Designed and executed test scenarios to validate business requirements and backend data integrity for distributed mission-critical applications (Nutrien), automating REST APIs with Postman to reduce manual validation by 50%.
- Delivered quality assurance and test automation for high-impact government public service platforms (ESDC / Service Canada), validating dual-interface workflows using TypeScript and Selenium, and simulating container outages/overload scenarios on Docker and Kubernetes in Azure DevOps.
- Performed security-focused API testing with Postman and GraphQL queries for digital asset management platforms (AMD Silo AI), identifying vulnerabilities in authentication, authorization, and data exposure, and reducing regression cycles by 70%.
- Validated 15+ cloud workflows and resilience across AWS services including Cognito, S3, AppSync, Lambda, and MongoDB.
- Integrated automated test suites into CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Azure DevOps with configured Allure reporting.
- Drove Agile QA processes in sprint planning, defect triage, and risk identification to support biweekly deployments and release readiness.
- Mentored junior engineers in test automation, code reviews, and API testing; presented project outcomes company-wide, receiving formal recognition and being featured in the corporate newsletter.

Software QA Engineer – Imperva *Jun 2021 - Nov 2022*

- Performed Functional, Exploratory, Regression, Browser Compatibility, and GUI testing of an industry-leading Cybersecurity product (Data Security Fabric).
- Built hybrid automation framework using Selenium, Java, and TestNG, increasing automation coverage by 30%.
- Reduced manual API testing by 80% through automated Postman and Newman test suites.
- Created 8+ custom automation scripts to reduce manual steps and streamline expected results using Shell scripts, APIs, and SQL queries.
- Conducted compatibility and data integrity testing across supported databases including SQL Server, AWS Redshift, and MongoDB.
- Automated end-to-end test scenarios simulating real-world attack surfaces, validating MFA, SSO, and authentication mechanisms within containerized Docker environments on AWS EC2.

Test Automation Engineer – Wipro *Aug 2018 - Aug 2019*

- Created comprehensive test plans, executed tests, tracked and validated bugs, and reported issues as Jira tickets following software testing best practices.
- Performed extensive backend testing using SQL queries to validate data integrity in SQL Server.
- Conducted regression, functional, and user acceptance testing for enterprise applications, validating end-to-end user workflows.
- Dealt with final sign-off for migrated applications from the client, ensuring high quality, software reliability, and customer trust.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

AI & Quality Engineering: AI-Assisted Test Automation, AI Agents, Claude, Antigravity, LLM Feature Validation

Test Automation: Playwright, pytest, Selenium, Postman, Newman, Allure, JUnit, TestNG

Languages: Python, TypeScript, SQL, Java, Bash

API & Backend Testing: REST APIs, GraphQL, Postman, Newman, Swagger, AppSync

Databases: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS Redshift, AWS DocumentDB

Cloud, CI/CD & Reliability: Microsoft Azure, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Git

Defect Management & Collaboration: Jira, X-Ray, Zephyr, Azure DevOps, VS Code, Figma

EDUCATION

Master of Science - Computer Science – Western University (Dec 2020)

Bachelor of Technology – M.S. Institute of Technology (Jun 2018)